Cyber Security Incident Response Plan for Network Intrusion

1. Purpose and Scope

This plan defines the procedures for responding to a network intrusion, where an unauthorised attacker gets access to internal systems or data.

The plan is to minimise damage to company and systems, restore normal operations, and reduce the risk of recurrence.

2. Incident Detection and Identification

Intrusions may be detected through:

- Intrusion Detection/Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS)
- Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alerts
- Unusual network traffic or system behaviour
- User or administrator reports

Once an alert is raised, the incident will be logged and classified based on severity: low, medium, or high.

Severity depends on data sensitivity, system criticality, and scope of compromise.

3. Analysis and Assessment

The response team will analyse:

- Source and method of intrusion
- Affected systems, accounts, and data
- Whether lateral movement or data exfiltration occurred

4. Containment

Containment actions depend on attack severity:

- **Low risk:** Isolate endpoints that have been targeted and restrict appropriate user accounts
- **Medium risk:** Segment affected network areas and block malicious IP addresses
- **High risk:** Disconnect compromised systems from the network

Containment aims to stop further attacker activity while keeping the business running.

5. Eradication

Once attack is contained:

- Eliminating malware
- Patch any found vulnerabilities
- Reset user credentials
- Removing unauthorised accounts

6. Recovery

Clean systems are restored from trusted backups, monitored closely, and gradually returned to production.

7. Post-Incident Review

A lessons-learned review is conducted to assess effectiveness, update controls, and improve future response readiness.